



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Going Back to The Origins of The Software Industry



Learning Outcome:

Identify information about the history of software and its characteristics in simple spoken and written situations.

Ask your partner:

- Why were spreadsheet applications and word processors important for the PC software industry?
- Why do you think spreadsheet applications and word processors were first invented?

Can Do Statements:

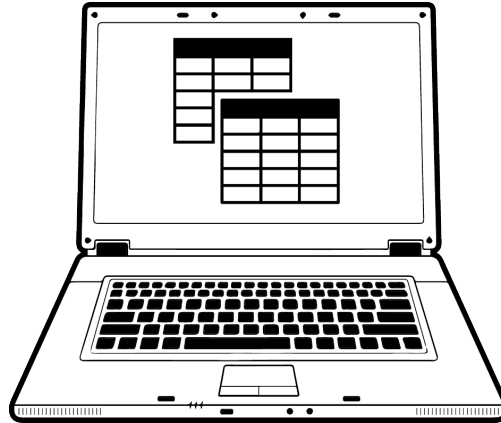
- I can discuss ideas about the starting point of the PC software industry.
- I can talk about the origins of spreadsheet applications for microcomputers.
- I can talk about the origins of word processing programs for microcomputers.





Let's Explore!

How were the word processor and spreadsheet program born?



Instructions: Read the text below.

Halley: Hello, Mike! Were you able to research about the PC Software Industry?

Mike: Hey, Halley! Yes. That's a very interesting subject.

Halley: Is the PC software industry successful thanks to the word processors?

Mike: Well, there are two key applications that revolutionized the software industry: spreadsheet programs and word processors.

Halley: Why are they so important?

Mike: They are responsible for triggering the growth of the mainframe and minicomputer software industry. Thanks to these applications, more people see how computers make our lives easy.

Halley: What are the origins of spreadsheet applications?

Mike: According to this web page, in 1979, Bricklin releases the first spreadsheet program after listening to his teacher saying that large companies divided blackboards into rows and columns for production planning. He thinks he can simplify this process by creating a program. So, Bricklin decides to try his invention on the Apple II. Not long after, there are imitations of the project, which helps revolutionize the accounting and financial management fields.

Halley: Does the word processor have the same popularity?

Mike: Yes, as there are more and more microcomputers in the market, the relevance of creating an application that makes the writing process easier becomes a very important goal; later on, new technology advances allows users to edit on-screen and store the information on floppy disks. Finally, by 1976, Michael Shrayler releases the first-word processor for microcomputers, which is rudimentary, but commercially successful. After this program, new developments help the word processor become an even more popular application.

Halley: There is a lot to learn about the PC software industry! We are used to all this technology but we don't usually think about its origins and evolution.

Mike: Exactly! We must learn more!



Let's Practice!

The Starting Point of the PC Software Industry

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences.

Is the PC / do / see / That is / there are

1. What _____ you know about the origins of the PC Software Industry?
2. _____ a very interesting subject.
3. _____ software industry successful thanks to the word processors?
4. Well, _____ two key applications that revolutionized the software industry: spreadsheet programs and word processors.
5. Thanks to these applications, more people _____ now how useful computers are.



Let's Practice!

True Facts about the Origins of Word Processing Programs

Instructions: Read the following sentences based on the text. In front of each sentence write True or False.

1. In the late 1970s, spreadsheet programs and word processors became very popular.

2. As there are more and more microcomputers in the market, the relevance of creating an application that makes the writing process easier becomes a very important goal.

3. Later on, new technology advances allowed users to edit on-screen and store the information in USBs. _____





Extension Activity

Identifying some examples about spreadsheet applications.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Make a brochure about the origins of the PC software industry.
- Show specific examples of the first important applications created.
- Give examples of the first spreadsheet and word processing programs.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

- I share information about the starting point of the PC software industry.
- I give specific information about the origins of spreadsheet applications.
- I talk about the origins of word processing programs for microcomputers.

☐	☐
☐	☐
☐	☐



Target Words

- blackboard** (noun): a rigid surface that is used for writing with chalk or markers
e.g. In 1979, Bricklin releases the first spreadsheet program after listening to his teacher saying that large companies divided blackboards into rows and columns for production planning.
- floppy disk** (noun): a small disk that is inserted in the computer for transferring data
e.g. New technology advances allows users to edit on-screen and store the information on floppy disks.
- research** (verb): to search for information in a systematic way
e.g. Were you able to research about the PC Software Industry?
- edit on-screen** (verb): to modify information by looking at the changes on a screen
e.g. New technology advances allows users to edit on-screen and store the information on floppy disks.
- revolutionize** (verb): to bring radical changes
e.g. There are two key applications that revolutionized the software industry: spreadsheet programs and word processors.
- trigger** (verb): to help start something
e.g. They are responsible for triggering the growth of the mainframe and minicomputer software industry.



Learning Points

Simple Present Tense in Statements and Questions

We use the **simple present tense** to talk about actions that are generally true or that are happening in the present.

We use **the simple present tense** frequently in English. Let's review first, a little bit about the verb 'to be' in simple present.

Affirmative	Interrogative	Interrogative with 'wh' questions
<i>I am an engineer.</i>	<i>Am I an engineer?</i>	<i>Why am I an engineer?</i>
<i>(they, you we) You are a software developer.</i>	<i>Are you a software developer?</i>	<i>Why are you a software developer?</i>
<i>(He, she, It) The processor is new.</i>	<i>Is the processor new?</i>	<i>Why is the processor new?</i>

For the other verbs different from the verb 'to be', we are going to follow the same grammatical structure.

For regular verbs, we are just going to add an 's' at the end of the verb for the third person singular (he, she, it).

Example:

*She **designs** a spreadsheet.*

When we want to ask a question in **simple present** with a verb different from the verb 'to be', we use the auxiliary verb **do** or **does**.

Example:

***Do** you **like** developing new software?*

We use 'does' when the subject of the sentences is singular, and 'do' when the subject is plural.

Examples

- Is the PC software industry successful thanks to the word processors?*
- Why are they so important?*
- Does the word processor have the same popularity?*
- They are responsible for triggering the growth of the mainframe and minicomputer software industry.*
- In 1979, Bricklin releases the first spreadsheet program.*





Learning Points

Differences Between Spreadsheets and Word Processors

Spreadsheets and **word processors** are very useful applications that allow you to carry out different tasks. Let's see how these two are different.

SPREADSHEETS

We use spreadsheets to enter numeric data in order to make different calculations by using formulas. Once we process the data, we are able to see the information in an organized way. We use spreadsheets mainly for processing numeric data.

WORD PROCESSOR

We use word processors for writing documents that can be easily edited. We can use this application for modifying the font, the style, for adding charts or graphics, among others. We use word processors mainly for working with alphabetic data.

Example

- *There are two key applications that revolutionized the software industry: spreadsheet programs and word processors.*